

Akshay Kandhare

AWS Cloud Engineer | AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate

Email: kandhareakshay123@gmail.com | Phone: +91 87677 44356 | Location: Pune, India | LinkedIn: linkedin.com/in/akshaykandhare | Portfolio: akshaykandhare.github.io

Professional Summary

AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate with 5 years' experience designing, deploying and migrating production cloud infrastructure. Built EKS clusters, Amazon MQ (ActiveMQ) brokers, OpenSearch clusters and ElastiCache (Redis) from the ground up, migrated 60 banking clients from on-premises to AWS, and delivered production migrations with zero data loss and no downtime. Skilled in Infrastructure as Code, CI/CD, centralised monitoring and cloud security, with a focus on reliable, well-documented change delivery.

Work Experience

AWS Solutions Specialist

MeWhiz Services Pvt. Ltd | Uttar Pradesh, India | Sep 2024 - Present

- Deployed production AWS infrastructure end to end: EKS clusters with managed node groups, Amazon MQ (ActiveMQ) brokers, OpenSearch clusters and ElastiCache (Redis), sized and secured.
- Delivered a zero-data-loss ElastiCache (Redis) security update across dev, UAT and production OAuth clusters using a snapshot-first method with documented validation and rollback.
- Completed a zero-downtime RabbitMQ migration from Amazon Linux 2 to Amazon Linux 2023 via blue/green cutover, preserving every vhost, queue, user and policy.
- Migrated a self-managed Elasticsearch workload to Amazon OpenSearch, including reverse-proxy compatibility assessment, cutover plan and post-migration validation.
- Automated S3 and CloudFront static site delivery with CloudFormation, turning manual setup into repeatable, version-controlled releases; deployed AWS WAF to block common web attacks.
- Reduced CloudFront spend through bytes-downloaded analysis and raised the approved change request.
- Built centralised Kubernetes monitoring across multiple EKS clusters with Prometheus and Grafana for a single view of cluster health.
- Automated detection and alerting for IAM console login failures and unauthorised access using CloudTrail, EventBridge and Lambda.

AWS Cloud Engineer

Community Brands Pvt. Ltd | Pune, India | May 2024 - Jul 2024

- Provisioned AWS infrastructure with Terraform and built Jenkins CI/CD pipelines, cutting manual deployment effort.
- Deployed monitoring tooling and implemented cross-region data collection.
- Applied AWS security and compliance best practices across provisioned environments.

AWS Engineer and Network Engineer

JJIT Fintech Pvt Ltd | Pune, India | Sep 2022 - May 2024

- Led the migration of 60 banking clients from on-premises data centres to AWS with no loss of service.
- Designed AWS cloud and network architecture for regulated banking workloads, ensuring secure and reliable connectivity.
- Configured site-to-site VPN for branch connectivity and deployed Oracle 19c on RDS with backup and snapshot policies.
- Automated remediation of low EC2 storage using PowerShell scripts.

EDP IT Assistant (Hardware and Networking)

Indrayani Co-Op Bank | Pimpri, Pune, India | Nov 2021 - Apr 2022

- Implemented and maintained servers on EC2, including administration and patching.
- Managed server operations and Active Directory configuration.
- Supported Fortigate and Sophos firewall deployment and routing.

Certifications

- AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate
- Security Engineering on AWS
- Architecting on AWS

Technical Skills

AWS Services: EKS, EC2, VPC, ELB, ALB, Auto Scaling, EBS, S3, RDS, Aurora, Route 53, OpenSearch, ElastiCache (Redis), RabbitMQ, Amazon MQ (ActiveMQ), Lambda, SQS, SNS, IAM, VPC Peering, VPN, AWS Backup, Lifecycle Manager

Infrastructure as Code and CI/CD: Terraform, CloudFormation, Jenkins, Ansible

Containers and Orchestration: Docker, Kubernetes, Amazon EKS, Amazon ECS, AWS Fargate

Monitoring and Logging: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, Node Exporter, CloudWatch, EventBridge, CloudTrail, AWS Config

Security: AWS WAF, IAM roles and policy management, GuardDuty, Inspector, Firewall Manager, MFA, encryption in transit and at rest

Networking: VPN, IP addressing, routing, NAT, NACL, AWS network firewall, Fortigate, Sophos

Databases: Amazon RDS, Oracle 19c, Aurora, backup, snapshot and restore, patching

Operating Systems and Scripting: Linux administration, Windows administration, Active Directory, Python, SQL, PowerShell

Education

- MBA, Business Analytics - Pune University, 2020-2022 (CGPA 8.75)
- B.Tech, Electronics - VIT College of Engineering, Pune, 2015-2018 (CGPA 7.8)